

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

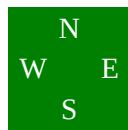
♠ 6  
 ♥ A 10 8 6 4  
 ♦ 10 7 3  
 ♣ J 8 3 2

♠ A Q 8 2

♥ 7 5 3

♦ Q 6 4

♣ A 9 5



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 9

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ Q 10 4

♠ J 10 9 4

♥ K Q 2

♦ A K 9

♣ K 7 6

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

You have lost two tricks so far. Lead the ♠J and let it ride. East wins their third trick with the ♠K but has no ♥ to return so he plays a ♦ which you win with your ♦A.

Play off your 7 winners and give up a ♣ at the end.

The K Q x holding is similar to the A J x holding. It might be two stoppers, or might just be one, depending on which defender next leads the suit.

So you decide whether to hold up or not based on how you expect to play the hand.

With his 4-3-3-3 distribution North chooses not to bother with Stayman. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥6. East plays the ♥J.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need to get two more winners. The ♥ suit might provide one of them, but you will still have to establish ♠s. The burning question is whether to win the first ♥ or to hold up. If you take this trick you will have a second stopper if West takes the lead, but you will be in extreme danger if East takes the lead. Since the ♠ finesse has to go into East you should hold up.

East returns the ♥9, West takes the ♥A and clears the suit.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 3  
♥ A 10 8 6 4  
♦ 10 7 3  
♣ J 8 3

♠ J 10 9 4

♥ 7 5 3

♦ A K 9

♣ A 9 5



♠ 7 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ Q 10 4 2

♠ A Q 8 2

♥ K Q 2

♦ Q 6 4

♣ K 7 6

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|      |       |      | 1NT   |

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

With his 4-3-3-3 distribution North chooses not to bother with Stayman. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥6. East plays the ♥J.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need to get two more winners. The ♥ suit might provide one of them, but you will still have to establish ♠s. The burning question is whether to win the first ♥ or to hold up. If you take this trick you will have a second stopper if West takes the lead, but you will be in extreme danger if East takes the lead. Since the ♠ finesse has to go into West you should not hold up.

You win with your ♥K, (keeping West in the dark about who holds the ♥Q), enter dummy with the ♦A and play the ♠J, letting it ride to West's ♠K.

West cannot play ♥s without setting up your ♥Q so he will probably exit with a ♣ which you take with the ♣K.

Play off your 6 winners and concede the last three tricks.

This was almost the same as Deal 5, the difference being in which direction the ♠ finesse had to be taken.

But it sure makes a big difference in how you play the hand.

This might have turned out even better. If West had decided to play his partner for the ♥Q, (who would have played ♥J from a holding of ♥ Q J x), you would have made an overtrick!